

-
-
-
-
-

Chapter 1

Getting Started



Prerequisites

Please note that System 21 Technical Reference supports only the system configuration detailed separately on the latest System 21 Configuration Information Sheet issued by JBA Software Products Limited, although individual configurations can be agreed between clients and JBA Branches for local support of the product.

It is assumed that you are familiar with the standard elements of the Microsoft Windows interface, such as the controls for opening and closing windows.

Technical Reference is installed when you install JBA's Administration Tools during the System 21 Explorer Installation. However for Technical Reference to work you must also purchase and install the databases.



Note: Please refer to System 21 Technical Information for Installation Instructions.

What Is Technical Reference?

Technical Reference is an inquiry facility providing a complete cross-reference of server application programs, databases, activities and menus for JBA System 21 applications. It is designed for you to explore, in detail, the technical structure of the System 21 product.

It is primarily intended for Designers who want to perform an impact analysis. For example you might want to add a new field to the Item Master File and are aware that this could impact on every program which uses the file. You could use Technical Reference to find out the names of all the programs which use the Item Master File. This is a simple example but using Technical Reference you can navigate freely and make inquiries to numerous logical levels.



Note: You can copy information from the database to your clipboard but you cannot update the database in any way.

You have a choice of three separate databases for each standard of the environments: Generic, Drinks and Style.

Opening And Closing Technical Reference

Opening

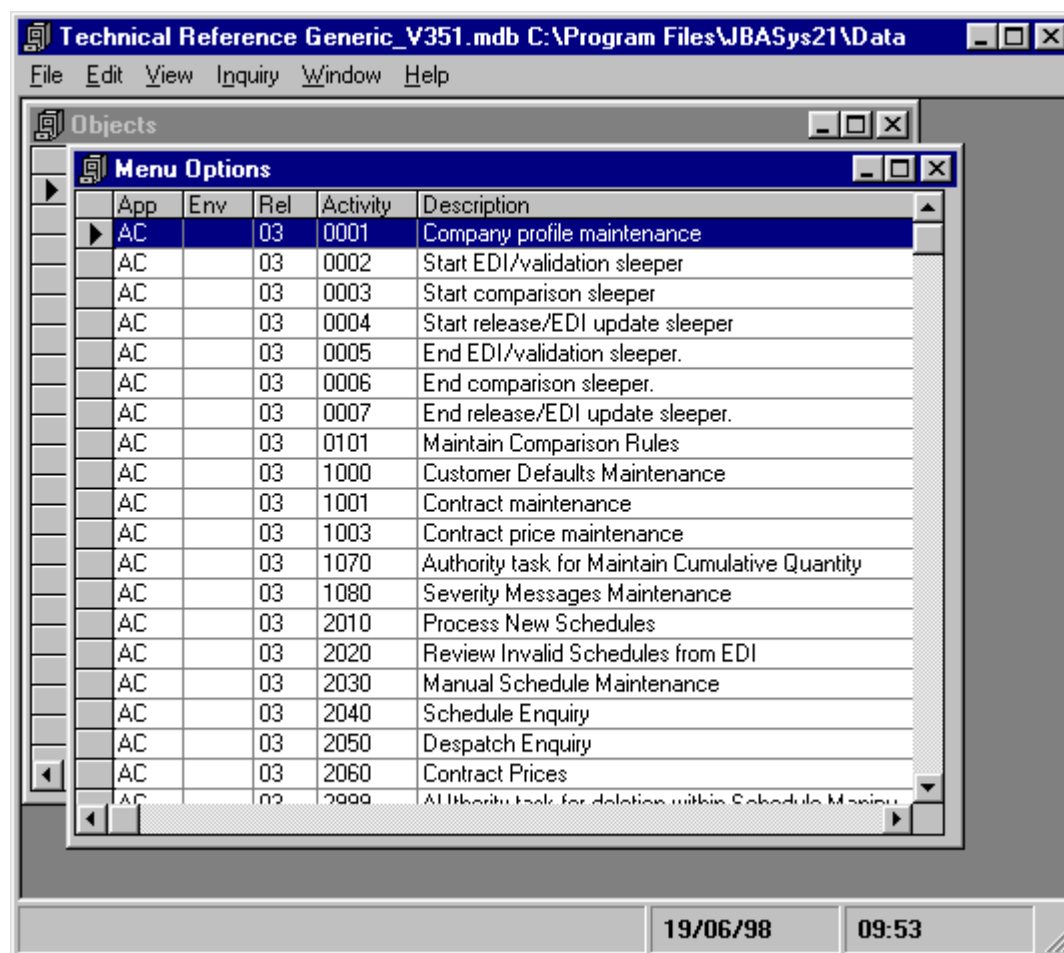
To open Technical Reference go to your Windows Start Menu and select:

Programs > JBA System 21 > JBA System 21 Technical Reference.

This takes you straight into the view over the database.



Tip: If this is the first time you have accessed Technical Reference, you may need to specify where the database is located using the standard Windows File Open Window.



You also have in your program list:

JBA Help > JBA System 21 Technical Reference Help

This accesses the help, which you are reading now. You can also access the help from the Main Menu Bar within Technical Reference itself.

Closing

To close Technical Reference, select Exit from the File Menu on the Main Menu Bar.

What To Do First - Tutorial

This tutorial briefly introduces you to the capabilities and uses of Technical Reference. Please take a few minutes to go through all the steps:

Step 1 - About The Screen



Note: Technical Reference does not have a Toolbar.

The screen has four distinct areas. These are, starting from the top of the screen and going down to the bottom:

Title Bar



Tells you which database you are viewing.

Main Menu Bar



Six options, each with their own separate Help section.

Display Area

This is where the Grid Box displays the database information for you. The actual layout of the grid box depends upon the information displayed. For more information about this area, refer to later steps of the tutorial.

Status Bar



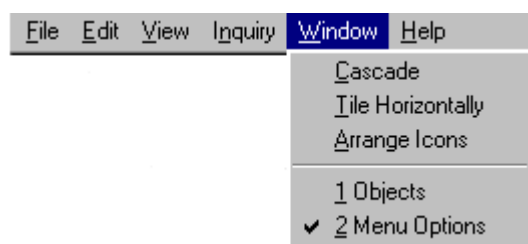
This is where any Progress Messages are displayed.

Step 2 - About The Two Main Windows

When you open a database within Technical Reference, there are two main windows opened:

- Objects - This displays the database details sorted into object order and positioned at the first object.
- Menu Options - This displays the database details sorted into menu option order and positioned at the first menu option.

Look at the Windows drop down menu on the Main Menu Bar. The two main windows are listed for you and Objects is first assigned as number 1.



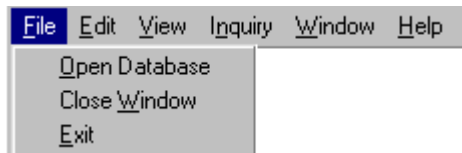
As you use Technical Reference to view the database in other ways you will see more windows being added to this list.

Only one window can be active at one time. This is a normal Microsoft Windows function. To change the active window either click on part of the window which you can see or select the window from the Window Menu.

Step 3 - Closing And Opening Windows

Closing

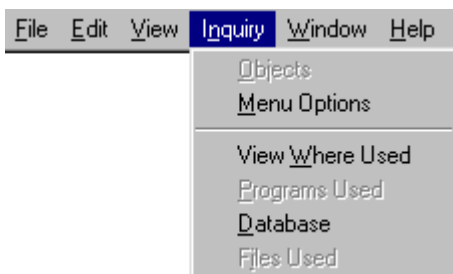
You can close the active window using the Close Window option from the File Menu.



Opening

You can always open the main windows using the Inquiry menu.

Try closing either the Objects Window or the Menu Options Window and then note that the name is listed at the top of the Inquiry Menu. Double click on the name in the Inquiry Menu and the window opens again.



You open other windows as you use Technical Reference to find out information. As you make requests for information the windows are displayed for you and are listed under the Windows Menu.

Step 4 - About Terminology

The Technical Reference database is displayed for you in a grid box.

This Help text refers to:

- Columns - going across, with the data displayed in a list going down the grid box.
- Rows - going down, with the data displayed going across the grid box.
- Elements - the individual cells.

The diagram shows a grid box with the following data:

	Object Name	Library	Type	Attribute	Description
	\$AUDIT	OSLCDF3	FILE	PF	Audit of the buffer
	\$CMBFF	OSLCDF3	FILE	PF	Communications buffer definition
	@APPARMS	OSLAQP3	FILE	PF	Configurator Parameters for advanced pricing
Row	@CNPAPMS	OSLAQP3	FILE	PF	Configurator Parameters place with Inventory files
	@CPIPGAC	OSLACD3	PGM	RPG	Common Program Interface Initialisation Program
	@CPIPGAI	OSLAIP3	PGM	RPG	Common Program Interface Initialisation Program
	@CPIPGAO	OSLAQP3	PGM	RPG	Common Program Interface Initialisation Program
	@CPIPGAS	OSLASD3	PGM	RPG	Common Program Interface Initialisation Program
	@CPIPGCD	OSLCDP3	PGM	RPG	Common Program Interface Initialisation Program

Annotations in the diagram:

- A dashed red box labeled "Column" spans the top row of the grid.
- A dashed red box labeled "Row" spans the fourth row of the grid.
- A solid red box labeled "Element" points to the cell containing "RPG" in the "Attribute" column of the fifth row.

Step 5 - Finding Information



Tip: Always remember: **Position then Inquire**.

There are two simple stages:

Position

Look down the left hand side of the display area for a black triangle.



This is the pointer which tells you where you are on the database.

Before you can find any information for a database element you must position yourself at the correct row.

To get to the right position you can use the following:

- The scroll bars at the right hand side of the window.
- The Find Window to move your pointer to a new row in the database by finding any piece of text within the Description column of the database. To display this window select Find from the View Menu.
- The Position To Window to move your pointer to a new row in the database by searching for either: an Object - if you are viewing the Objects Window, or an Application Name - if you are viewing the Menu Options Window. To display this window select Position To from the View Menu.

Inquire

Make an inquiry for the information you need. To do this use the options at the bottom half of the Inquiry Menu. These options are not all available at once:

If you are looking at the Objects Window, and have a logical or physical file highlighted, you can see:

- View Where Used
- Database.

If you are looking at the Menu Options Window, or the Objects Window with a program highlighted, you can see:

- View Where Used
- Programs Used
- Files Used.



Tip: To tell which type of file you have selected in the Objects Window, look at the Attributes Column. Logical Files display the attribute LF, Physical Files, PF and programs, RPG.



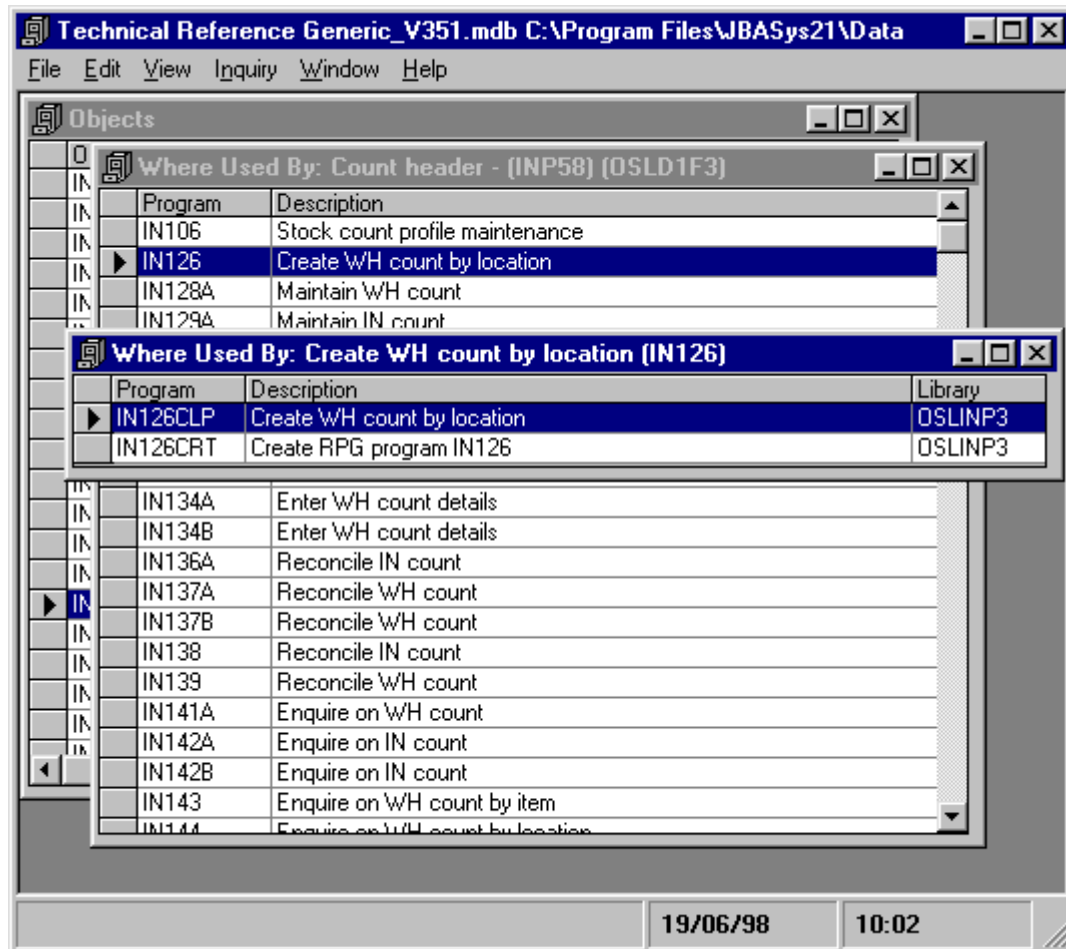
Note: If there is no information then you get this message: No records have been found.

Step 6 - Viewing Logical Levels

You can inquire on the database through as many levels as there is information available.

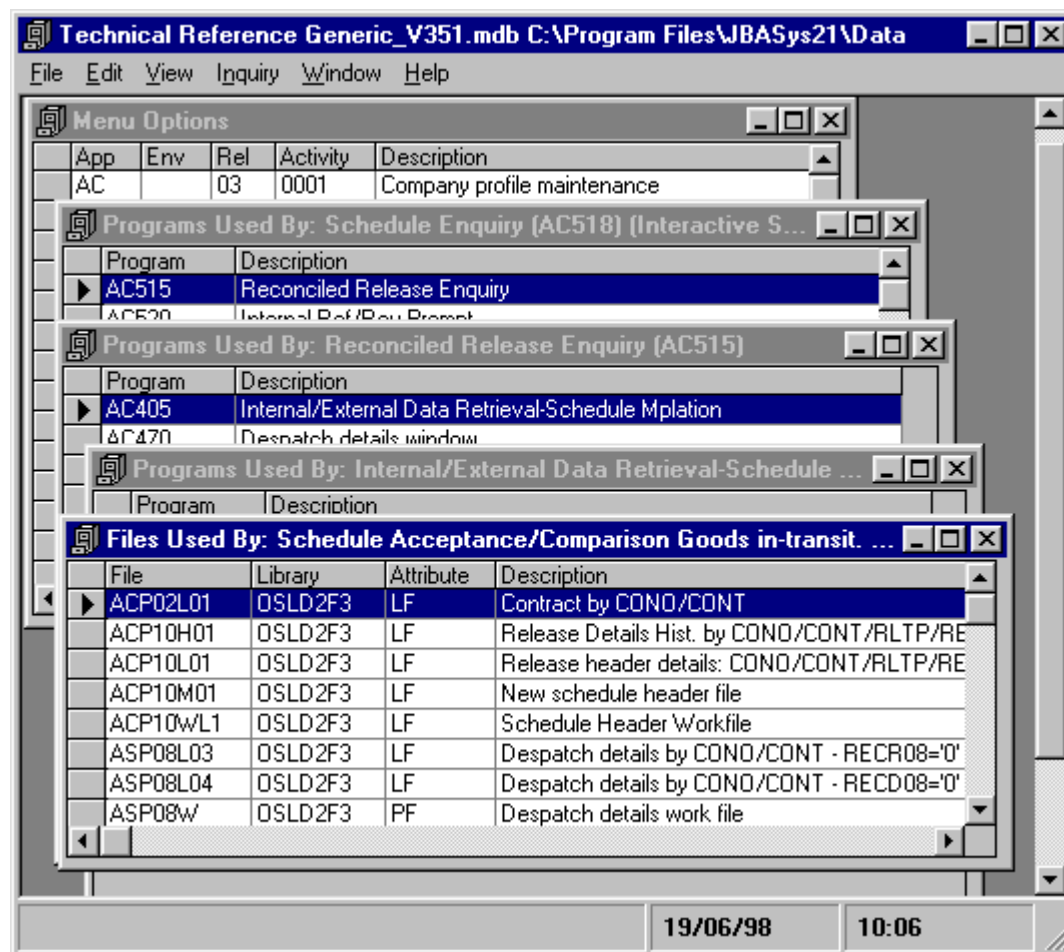
Example 1:

You could start with the Objects Window and position the pointer at the Object called INP58. Then select View Where Used from the Inquiry menu. This displays all the programs which use INP58. You could then position the pointer at one of the programs, for example: IN126 and select View Where Used again. This displays the programs which in turn call that program.



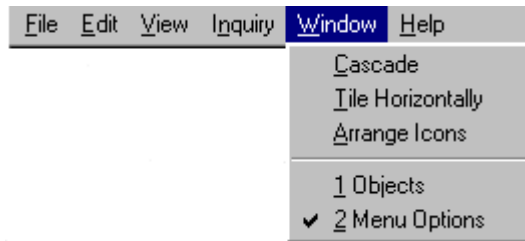
Example 2:

You could select a program from the Menu Options Window and go on to view the programs which this calls. You can keep doing this to find the complete calling pathway. At any point you could view the Files Used for any of the programs.

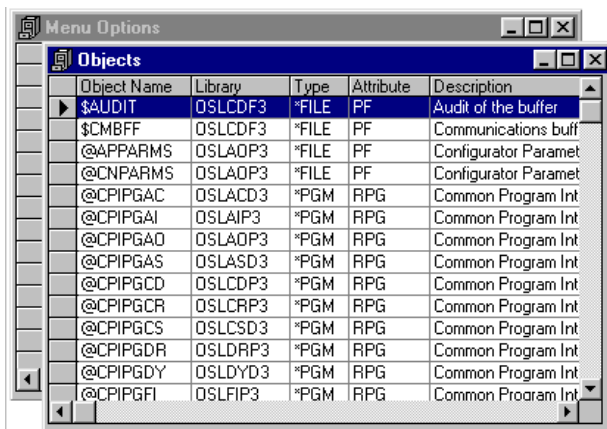


Step 7 - Arranging Windows

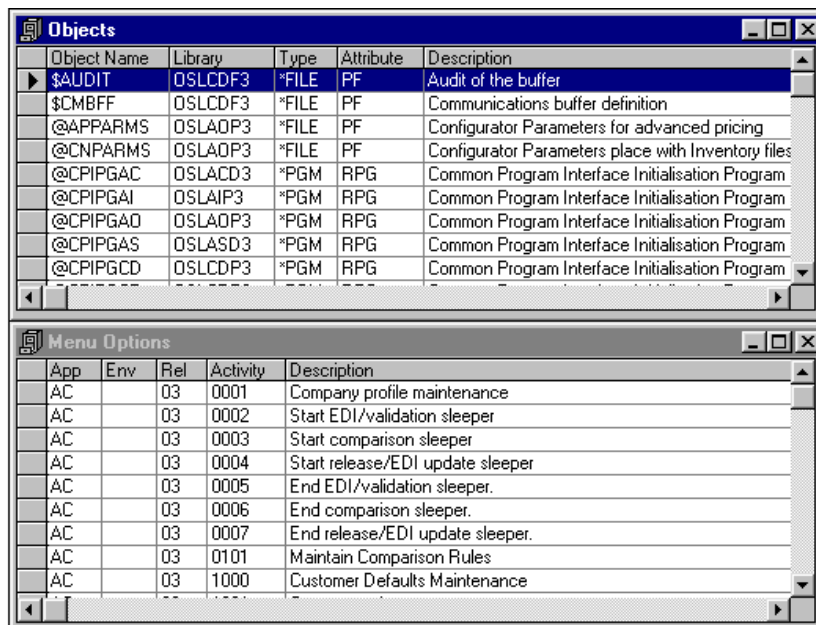
You can arrange the windows on the display area in three ways. To do this, use the options at the top of the Window menu: Cascade, Tile Horizontally and Arrange Icons.



Cascade arranges like this.



Tile Horizontally arranges like this.

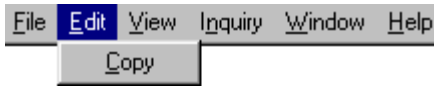


The Arrange Icons option only works when the windows have been minimised and moved around the display area. You can line them up like this.



Step 8 - Copying Information To The Clipboard

Using normal Microsoft Windows functions, highlight the information you want to copy.



Select Copy from the Edit Menu to make the information available in the Clipboard. You can then copy from the clipboard into other applications such as Microsoft Word.